

First Read: Hotel Rwanda

Assigned by: Mr. A

Due: May 10, 2024 11:59 PM



Read

FADE IN:

INT. SABENA OFFICES -BELGIUM -TILLENS' OFFICE -DAY

1 The Sabena President and three VPs have an early morning meeting. The intercom buzzes.

TILLENS

2 Yes?

SECRETARY

3 (thru speaker phone)

4 Sorry, sir, but I have a call from Paul in Kigali. He says it's urgent.

5 The President hits the speaker button.

TILLENS

6 Paul. Are you all right?

PAUL

7 (thru speaker phone)

8 We have a big problem, sir.

TILLENS

9 What?

PAUL

10 (thru speaker phone)

11 The Hutu ¹ Army have come. They've ordered us -all of us -out of the hotel.

TILLENS

12 Why are they doing this?

PAUL

13 (thru speaker phone)

14 I think they will kill us all.

TILLENS

15 (stunned)

16 Kill? What do you mean ...all? How many?

PAUL

17 (thru speaker phone)

18 We have one hundred staff, and now more than
eight hundred guests.

19 Tillens can barely form words to reply

TILLENS

20 Eight hundred!

PAUL

21 (thru speaker phone)

22 Yes, sir. There are now eight hundred Tutsi
i and Hutu **refugees**. I do not have much
time left, sir. I want to thank you for
everything you have done for me and my
family, and please thank all of my friends
at Sabena.

23 The President considers this.

TILLENS

24 Paul, wait. I'm gonna put you on hold. Stay
by the phone.

25 He hits the hold button, looks to the other executives. They are stunned to silence by
Paul's **profound** farewell.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -MANAGER'S OFFICE -DAY

26 Paul sits in the office, his hand over the mouthpiece. From the lobby come soldiers'
angry voices.

SOLDIER (O.S.)

27 Where are your papers?

INT. SABENA OFFICES -BELGIUM -TILLEN'S OFFICE -DAY

28 The President gets everyone working on the phone.

TILLENS

29 Louis, get on to the UN. Tell them what's
happening. Mary, call the Prime Minister's
office. Tell them I must speak with him now.

30 The President lifts the telephone receiver and hits a button.

TILLENS

31 Paul, are you there?

PAUL

32 (thru speaker phone)

33 Yes, sir.

TILLENS

34 Who can I call to stop this?

35 Paul thinks.

PAUL

36 (thru speaker phone)

37 The French -they supply the Hutu Army.

TILLENS

38 Do everything you can to bide time. I'll
call you right back.

39 Paul hurries from the room.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -LOBBY -DAY

40 Dube is at the computer, printing something. Paul walks quickly to him.

PAUL

41 What are you doing, Dube?

DUBE

42 The Lieutenant, sir. He wants to see the
guest list.

43 Paul nervously glances at the soldiers.

PAUL

44 Go and get these boys some more beer.

45 Dube walks to the bar to get the beer, and Paul is on the computer, typing. A
receptionist looks at the screen.

RECEPTIONIST

46 Sir, that guest list is from two weeks ago.

PAUL

47 Shh.

48 Paul hits the print button. The printer clicks to life.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -ENTRANCE -DAY

49 Paul emerges with the printed **registry**. The Lieutenant marches up to Paul.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

50 Where's the guest list?

51 Paul hands him the print out. The Lieutenant studies it.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

52 Anderson, Arthurs, Boulrier... What is this?

PAUL

53 It is the guest list, sir.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

54 Are you trying to make a fool out of me?

PAUL

55 No. We stopped taking names after the President was murdered. This is the only guest list, sir.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

56 There are no Europeans left. Get me the names of all the cockroaches in there, now.

PAUL

57 That will take time.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

58 You don't have time. If I don't have the names so that I can pick out the traitors, then I'll kill everyone in there. Starting with you.

59 The Lieutenant's radio comes to life and he turns to answer it. He listens for a moment

HUTU LIEUTENANT

60 (intro radio)

61 Yes, sir?

62 He angrily turns to Paul and grabs him.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

63 Who did you call?

PAUL

64 Who did I call?

HUTU LIEUTENANT

65 Don't lie to me! What is your name?

PAUL

66 Rusesabagina. Paul Rusesabagina.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

67 I'll remember you.

68 He prods Paul's chest.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

69 I'll remember you.

70 He turns to his soldiers, gestures.

HUTU LIEUTENANT

71 Let's go.

72 They drive off.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -ROOF -DAY

73 Paul emerges onto the roof. He looks around for his family, sees Tatiana, his children and the neighbors sitting huddled together.

PAUL

74 They've gone.

TATIANA

75 Oh.

76 Tatiana grabs him.

TATIANA

77 I was so afraid for you.

78 Dube appears.

DUBE

79 Sir, the President of Sabena is on the phone for you.

80 Paul strokes Tatiana's face.

PAUL

81 I must talk with this man.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -MANAGER'S OFFICE -DAY

82 Paul hits the button and lifts the telephone receiver.

PAUL

83 Mr. Tillens.

TILLENS

84 (thru phone)

85 Paul, what's going on?

86 Paul shakes his head in disbelief.

PAUL

87 They left. Thank you, sir. What did you do?

INT. SABENA OFFICES -BELGIUM -TILLEN'S OFFICE -DAY

88 The Sabena President is at his desk.

TILLENS

89 I got through to the French President's office.

PAUL

90 (thru speaker phone)

91 Well, thank you. You have saved our lives.

TILLENS

92 I pleaded with the French and the Belgians
to go back and get you all. I'm afraid this
is not going to happen.

93 Silence, Tillens is ashamed, angry.

TILLENS

94 They're cowards, Paul. Rwanda is not -worth
a single vote to any of them. The French,
the British, the Americans. I am sorry,
Paul.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -MANAGER'S OFFICE -DAY

95 Paul is stunned.

PAUL

96 Thank you.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -FUNCTION ROOM -DAY

97 The refugees are gathered, Paul addresses them.

PAUL

98 There will be no rescue. No **intervention**
force. We can only save ourselves. Many of
you know influential people abroad. You must
call these people.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -MANAGER'S OFFICE -DAY

99 **MONTAGE** of influential refugees. Odette, Benedict, Xavier call, plead, write and send
faxes.

100 Odette sits at the desk, on the phone.

PAUL

101 You must tell them what will happen to us.

102 Other refugees are on the phones.

PAUL

103 Say goodbye. But when you say goodbye, say
it as though you are reaching through the
phone and holding their hand. Let them know
that if they let go of that hand... you will
die. We must shame them into sending help.
Most importantly, this can not be a refugee
camp. The Interahamwe believe that the Mille
Collines is a four-star Sabena hotel. That
is the only thing keeping us alive.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -LOBBY -DAY

104 Paul on the move, organizing, walks to the receptionist at the front desk.

PAUL

105 Have you printed the bills?

106 She hands him a stack of envelopes.

PAUL

107 Now please erase the registry.

RECEPTIONIST

108 Erase it?

PAUL

109 Yes. I want no names to appear there.

110 Dube joins him.

DUBE

111 Boss, the carpenters are ready.

PAUL

112 Tell them to remove all of the numbers from the doors.

DUBE

113 And put what?

PAUL

114 And put nothing.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -HALLWAY -DAY

115 Paul goes door to door, knocking. The rooms are all packed with Tutsi refugees. A door opens. He hands an envelope to the refugee.

PAUL

116 Good day. Here is your bill for the last week. If you cannot pay, or think you will not be able to pay, please go to the banquet room and Dube will take care of you. Thank you.

INT. HOTEL MILLE COLLINES -GROUNDS -NIGHT

117 Refugees are clustered on the ground, in tents, as the radio voice plays over a reporter's interview of a State Department Officer.

AMERICAN REPORTER

118 (thru radio)

119 Does the State Department have a view as to whether or not what is happening -could be genocide?

STATE DEPARTMENT OFFICER

120 (thru radio)

121 We have every reason to believe that acts of genocide have occurred.

122 Inside his office Paul and the others listen.

BRITISH REPORTER

123 (thru radio)

124 How many acts of genocide does it take to
make genocide?

STATE DEPARTMENT OFFICER

125 (thru radio)

126 Alan, that's not a question that I'm in a
position to answer.

BRITISH REPORTER

127 (thru radio)

128 Is it true that you have specific guidance
not to use the word genocide in isolation,
but always to preface it with this word,
"acts of"?

STATE DEPARTMENT OFFICER

129 (thru radio)

130 I have guidance which I try to use as best I
can. There are formulations that we are
using that we are trying to be consistent in
our use of.

131 Paul is listening to all of this. Benedict turns off the radio in disgust.

Pp. 71-9 from *Hotel Rwanda* by Terry George and Keir Pearson. Compilation ©2005 by Newmarket Press. Used by permission of HarperCollins Publishers.

Annotations
